

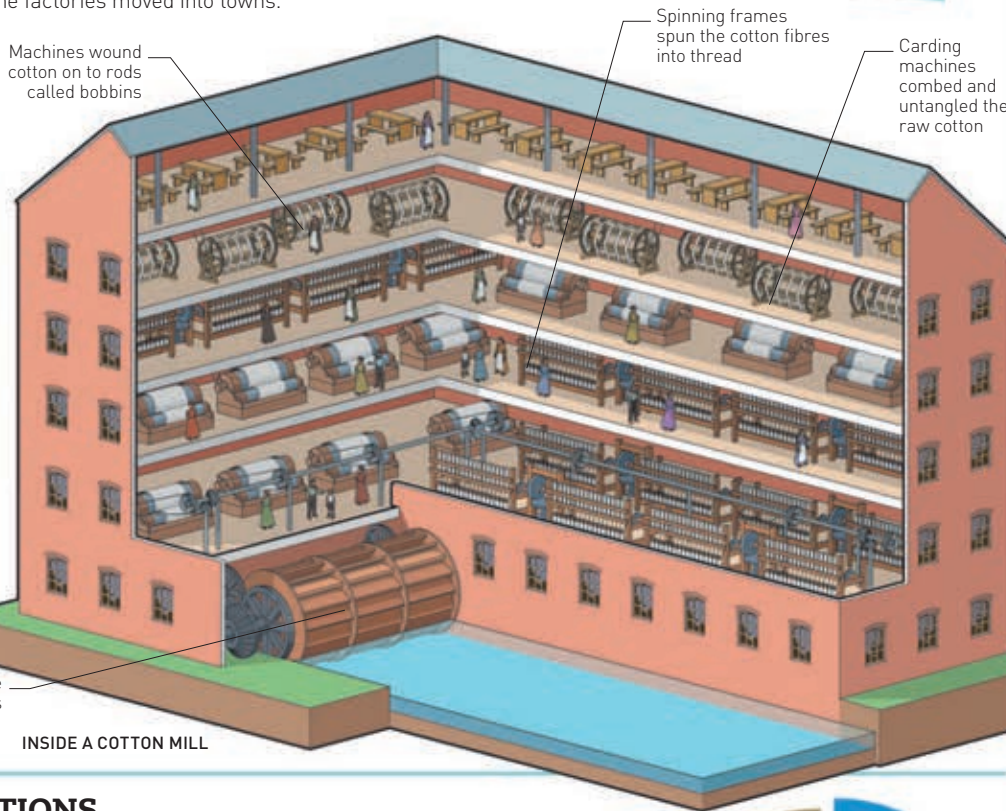
THE FACTORY AGE

Traditional industries such as cotton and textiles were transformed by the Industrial Revolution. Machines were developed that could make raw cotton into thread in a fraction of the time it had taken craft workers in the past. At first, the machines were powered by water, so mills and factories were built next to rivers. When steam replaced water power, the factories moved into towns.



REGULATIONS
Factory life was harsh. Workers could be fined just for whistling, or being five minutes late.

Flowing water turned the wheel to power the machines



INSIDE A COTTON MILL

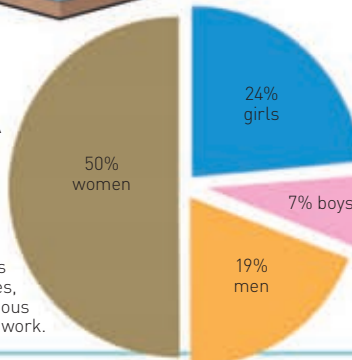
WORK CONDITIONS

Factory workers worked more than 12 hours a day, six days a week. At the start of the Industrial Revolution there were no laws to protect the health or safety of workers. Factories were hot and deafeningly noisy, and accidents and injuries were very common.



PIT CHILDREN
Children worked deep underground in coal mines, pulling heavy wagons along tracks.

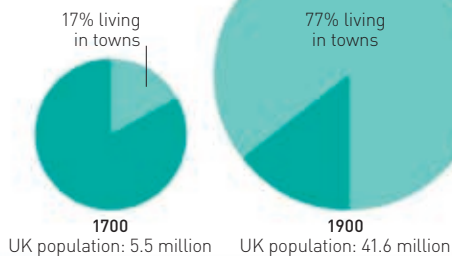
WORKERS IN A COTTON MILL, 1859
A third of mill workers were children, aged as young as five. They wriggled between machines to clear blockages, which was strenuous and dangerous work.



RISE OF THE NEW TOWNS

As more and more factories were built, towns grew and housing, schools, and shops were built near to where people worked. Small towns quickly became large, factory-dominated cities, which attracted even more people in search of work.

THE MOVE FROM COUNTRYSIDE TO TOWN IN THE UK



FARM TECHNOLOGY

As the population grew, there was an increased demand for more food and more efficient, cheaper ways of growing it. Steam-powered ploughs and threshing machines appeared in the 1820s, then in 1831, American Cyrus McCormick invented a mechanical grain harvester.



STEAM THRESHING MACHINE

THE NEW SPINNING MACHINES PRODUCED COTTON 1,000 TIMES FASTER THAN A HUMAN WORKER COULD

TIMELINE OF A REVOLUTION

The invention of steam power was a turning point in history. It also sparked major developments in other areas, including communications, transport, and construction.

